RAJASTHAN: LITMUS TEST FOR CM BHAJAN PG 13

J&K: COMPETING FOR TURF PG 18

DOCTOR DEATHS: A SILENT CRISIS PG 20

AP: RETURN OF 'CEO' NAIDU PG 22



FUTILE EFFORT Forest officials and vets try to revive a poisoned elephant in Bandhavgarh, Oct. 29

MP/ELEPHANT DEATHS

A TRAGEDY OF JUMBO PROPORTIONS

By Rahul Noronha

October 29 happened to be *Dhanteras*, an auspicious occasion two days before Diwali. Almost everyone—rangers, drivers, forest guards, tour operators, indeed all associated with the economy and management of the Bandhavgarh National Park in Madhya Pradesh—was in a festive mood. Cheer, however, soon turned into gloom. That afternoon, the wireless at the park HQ Tala crackled and came to life, informing park authorities about four dead elephants in the core area near Salkhania, a village located in the buffer zone. More elephants were said to be unwell, prompting